

What It Looks Like When You Don't Know You're Trauma Bonded

This wasn't just a messy breakup. It was a cycle of psychological en



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I am going to tell a story about a client of mine. I am keeping the de
her privacy.

If someone had told her she was trauma bonded, she wouldn't have
That was actually the first thing she said to me when we spoke.
was just deeply in love with someone complicated and she was tryin
She thought it was just a matter of learning how to communicate b
reached out to me.

But when we got on our first call, it was very clear she was being en
... connection.



... survivors, she had no ide

I won't sugarcoat it—this journey isn't clean or easy. It's messy and brutal, and there will be days when you feel like you're making no progress at all.

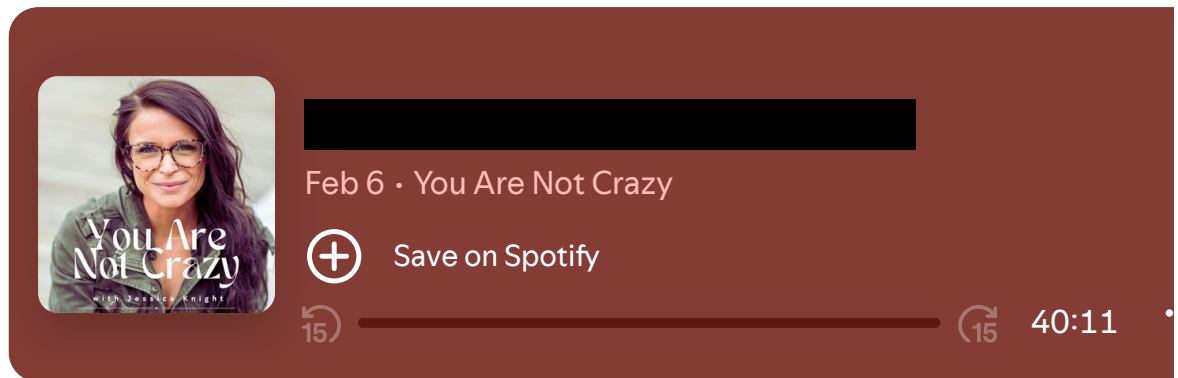
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What is a trauma bond?

A trauma bond is a psychological attachment to someone who *hurt*

intermittently soothes you. It forms when your nervous system cannot handle intimacy. When love gets tangled with fear, and safety becomes confusion.

This is a very limited description of a very complex thing. **You can find the full story on this here:**



This is how it showed up in her story:

- She tried to leave, more than once. He always pulled her back with promises (but she really believed them).
- He gave her just enough hope to stay confused, but never enough to leave. She blamed herself.
- He crossed sexual boundaries and said the most tender things and told her not to take anything he said seriously.
- He refused to call it a relationship. Then asked to remain close. When she set boundaries around it and kept pursuing the “relationship”

- He went silent for weeks, then reappeared like nothing happened
- He told her she wasn't the love of his life, but that she was radiant. That she was unhealthy, but amazing. That she failed him, but moved ahead.

She didn't call it abuse. She said she felt confused and that she didn't know where the boundary was anymore. **She said she couldn't stop thinking about building a new life for herself.**

That's a trauma bond.

I work with clients on all stages of a trauma bond. **You might be trapped if:**

- You feel more anxious than safe in the connection.
 - You constantly try to decode their words, moods, or silence.
 - You blame yourself for the hurt they caused.
 - You try to earn love through self-abandonment.
 - You stay loyal to their *potential*, even when their reality is harmful.
 - You feel addicted to the highs—and devastated by the lows.
 - You minimize red flags because of how strong the pull feels.
 - You feel ashamed for still caring.
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